

# Matthew Beardwell

Watford, Hertfordshire · [mbeardwell.com](https://mbeardwell.com) · [contact@mbeardwell.com](mailto:contact@mbeardwell.com)  
[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · [TryHackMe](#)

## Professional Summary

SOC Analyst Trainee with hands-on cybersecurity experience and a First-Class BSc (Hons) in Computer Science. Skilled in HUMINT-style OSINT investigative techniques, now applying this toward infosec workflows. Ranked in the top 2% globally on TryHackMe (114 completed rooms, 16 badges). Currently preparing for CompTIA Security+ to strengthen expertise in SIEM, SOC operations, and incident response.

## Technical Skills

- Security and Threat Detection:** SIEM (Splunk), Sysmon, Windows Logs, OSINT
- Scripting and Programming:** Python, Bash, PowerShell, C, ARM ASM
- Systems Admin:** Group Policy, Linux Hardening, Virtualisation
- Incident Response:** Wireshark, TCP/IP, Firewalls

## Cybersecurity Projects

**‘ActiveReconLite’: A Python Port Scanner** Feb 2025 – Mar 2025  
Built a Python-based TCP connect port scanner using multiprocessing. Scanned 65k ports in 5s (vs Nmap’s 5m). It validates user input, grabs banners, and writes results to a file. Demonstrates automation, socket programming, and parallel scanning.

Technologies: Python, Multiprocessing, Network Scanning  
[github.com/mbeardwell/active-recon-lite](https://github.com/mbeardwell/active-recon-lite)

**‘Faster Dynamically Instrumented Programs’ · Bachelor’s Thesis** Oct 2022 – May 2023  
Designed and implemented a dynamic code modification technique that intercepts processor instructions at run-time, demonstrating low-level reverse engineering and malware analysis applications.

Technologies: C, ARM Assembly, Dynamic Binary Instrumentation  
[github.com/mbeardwell/arm-fp-emu](https://github.com/mbeardwell/arm-fp-emu)

## Professional Experience

Building expertise during ongoing health recovery. Not currently available for roles. Open to future opportunities.

**SOC Training and Labs · TryHackMe (Self-Led Learning)** Feb 2022 – Present  
Developed hands-on expertise in SIEM, threat hunting, and security automation through 114 cybersecurity labs (Top 2% globally). Applied log analysis, detection logic, and SOC tooling in simulation labs.

**Retail Assistant · Max Spielmann (Prince’s Trust Work Placement)** Feb 2024 – Mar 2024  
Processed transactions, assisted customers with self-service kiosks and mobile integration, and ensured secure deletion of processed passport photos.

**Private Tutor · Freelance** Sep 2016 – Nov 2019  
Supported children with pre-GCSE homework, primarily in maths; adapted explanations to varying ability levels in informal settings.

**Research and Documentation Intern · Indo UK Institute of Health** Jun 2017 – Aug 2017  
Conducted market research on employee benefits and strategic partnerships, providing executives with key insights. Edited and reformatted high-level strategic documents that shaped discussions on a billion-pound health-care initiative.

## Education and Certifications

|                                              |            |           |
|----------------------------------------------|------------|-----------|
| <b>BSc (Hons) CS · King’s College London</b> | 1st Class  | 2018–2023 |
| <b>A-Levels · King’s Maths School</b>        | 4 A*s      | 2016–2018 |
| <b>GCSEs · John Lyon School</b>              | 9 A*s, 1 B | 2014–2016 |

### Certifications

|                    |                                          |                     |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| CompTIA            | Security+                                | (In Progress)       |
| TryHackMe          | Intro to Cyber Security                  | Feb 2024            |
| TryHackMe          | Pre-Security                             | Apr 2022            |
| Security Blue Team | Intro to OSINT                           | Jun 2025            |
| Prince’s Trust     | TEAM (12-week programme incl. First Aid) | Jan 2024 – Apr 2024 |

Updated: 27/06/2025